

YOUR WEEKLY MICROSOFT SENTINEL BRIEFING

Sentinel Weekly

NO. 06 · AUGUST 27 - SEPTEMBER 2, 2026

Sentinel itself shipped nothing new. The hunting material more than made up for it.

NEW EVERY THURSDAY · CURATED BY PHILLIPE CHAVES DE LIMA

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EDITION 06 · AUGUST 27 TO SEPTEMBER 2, 2026

Sentinel itself shipped nothing new this week, but Microsoft published two full intrusion writeups with hunting queries you can run today, and the identity side quietly did the heavy lifting.

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On the radar this week

- **TerminalFix campaign deploys a reverse tunnel through a multistage intrusion** (*Microsoft Security Blog, August 28*): ClickFix grew up. The fake Cloudflare Turnstile prompt now pushes victims into Windows Terminal instead of the Run dialog, then chains DLL sideloading of dui70.dll beside a legitimate LockScreenContentServer.exe, pulls its payload out of PNG images by steganography, and ends in a custom Python reverse tunnel that dials out over TLS 443, upgrades to a WebSocket and proxies SOCKS5 style traffic back into your network. Microsoft ships three advanced hunting queries with it.
- **Counterfeit installers to system compromise** (*Microsoft Security Blog, September 1*): Fake vendor download pages impersonating Razer, Microsoft Edge and Kaspersky, with a twist that matters operationally: the payload is regenerated server side, so app_setup.6653004.zip has a different hash on every download. Hash blocklists lose. The stable parts are the staging paths, the Defender exclusion writes and the C2 port set, and the post gives you queries for all three.
- **Stop identity attacks before they start with Microsoft ISPM recommendations** (*Microsoft Defender XDR Blog, August 31*): Identity security posture management framed as prevention rather than detection, aimed at the compromised identities, excessive privileges and misconfigured access that sit underneath most large breaches.
- **Instant revocation of service principal bearer tokens with CAE** (*Microsoft Entra Blog, revised September 2*): Continuous access evaluation applied to workload identities, so a service principal bearer

token can be killed before its natural lifetime expires. If you have ever watched a stolen app token stay valid for the rest of its hour, this is the gap being closed.

- **What's new in Microsoft Sentinel: August 2026** (*Microsoft Sentinel Blog, August 28*): The monthly recap landed. It leads with the AI powered playbook generator being generally available to all Sentinel customers, which we covered when it flipped earlier in August, so treat this one as the tidy index of the month rather than fresh news.
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In this edition

Shipped and live now

Nothing net new for Sentinel inside this window. The Learn what's new page for Sentinel has not moved since August 24, the Sentinel blog published exactly one post (the August recap above), and Azure Updates carried no Sentinel entry at all between August 27 and September 2.

That is the honest state of it. No new tables, no new connectors, no new detections, nothing in preview that moved. Three weeks running now, the Sentinel product strand has been quiet while the interesting work has come out of threat research and the identity stack. If you have been putting off a backlog week, this is the window for it.

Agentic SOC watch

Quiet. Security Copilot published nothing this week, and there was no agent news on Learn or Tech Community.

The August recap leads with the AI powered playbook generator being generally available to all Sentinel customers, which we reported back in Edition 03 when the docs flipped. Nothing has changed since. If you are only now picking it up, re-read the limits before you build on it: Python only, alert triggers only, 100 playbooks per tenant, 5,000 lines each, a 10 minute runtime cap and no playbook to playbook calls.

Next door: Defender XDR and Entra

- The Defender XDR ISPM post above is the one to read if your identity posture work has stalled at "we ran the report once."
- [Microsoft Entra: September 2026](#) is out, the usual thirty day roundup of GA and public preview identity and network access capabilities.
- From the [monthly Microsoft Security roundup](#): Defender Experts MDR P2 now covers third party data ingested through Sentinel, naming Palo Alto Networks, AWS and Okta. If you run a managed service on top of Sentinel, that changes what your provider can see. Entra Tenant Governance also reached GA.

The clock to watch

One short reminder, because it is now inside two weeks: the Azure Monitor HTTP Data Collector API stops working on September 14, 2026. If anything in your estate still writes to a workspace through it, including older custom connector code, that is a hard date and it is very close. We covered the full retirement list in Edition 04.

One query to steal

The TerminalFix chain hangs on classic sideloading: a legitimate signed binary sitting in a user writable folder, loading an attacker DLL from the same folder. That shape is cheap to hunt for and it generalises well past this one campaign.

```
// illustrative, validate in your workspace first
// Signed binaries loading a DLL out of the same user writable folder they run from
DeviceImageLoadEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FolderPath endswith ".dll"
| extend ExePath = tolower(InitiatingProcessFolderPath), DllPath = tolower(FolderPath)
| where ExePath startswith "c:\\users\\"
    or ExePath startswith "c:\\programdata\\"
    or ExePath startswith "c:\\windows\\temp\\"
| extend ExeDir = strcat_array(array_slice(split(ExePath, "\\"), 0, -2), "\\")
| extend DllDir = strcat_array(array_slice(split(DllPath, "\\"), 0, -2), "\\")
| where ExeDir == DllDir
| summarize FirstSeen = min(Timestamp), LastSeen = max(Timestamp),
    Devices = dcount(DeviceId), Folders = make_set(ExeDir, 5)
    by InitiatingProcessFileName, DllName = FileName
| where Devices <= 5
| order by LastSeen desc
```

Two things worth knowing before you run it. Summarize by the binary and DLL name, not by the folder: user profile paths differ per person, so grouping on the path makes every result look rare and the threshold stops doing any work. And use startswith on a lowercased path rather than has_any, because term matching on strings full of backslashes does not do what it looks like it does.

Tune the Devices threshold to your estate. Widely deployed line of business apps will light up first, so baseline them out once and keep the tail.

That's Edition 06

A thin week for Sentinel product news, a good week for hunting material. If you ran the sideloading query and it surfaced something interesting, or buried you in noise, tell me in the comments. I read every one and the tuning notes make the next edition better.

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Curated by Phillipe Chaves de Lima. New every Thursday.